Transit Accessibility Analysis

LA28 Mobility Study

Measuring Transit Accessibility

Before & After the 2028 Olympics

"How much and where do Twenty-Eight by '28 projects actually improve access to transit across Los Angeles County?"

GIS Kernel Density Analysis | Dec 07, 2025
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Source: LA Metro

Methods: Kernel Density Analysis

Comparing transit accessibility surfaces: 2025 baseline vs 2028

STEP 1
Build Scenario Layers
2025 baseline + 2028 improvements (rail, BRT, last-mile)

STEP 2
Run Kernel Density
800m search radius (~10-15 min walk to transit)

STEP 3
Compute Delta Raster
KD_2028 − KD_2025 = change in accessibility

STEP 4
Zonal Statistics by Tract
Classify tracts: None → Low → Medium → High improvement

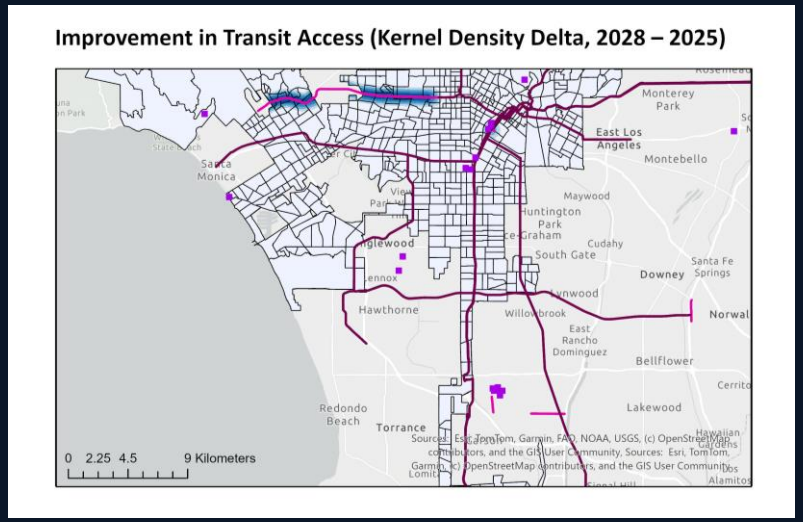
Data: LA GeoHub, LA Metro | Analysis: ArcGIS Pro

Map Symbology

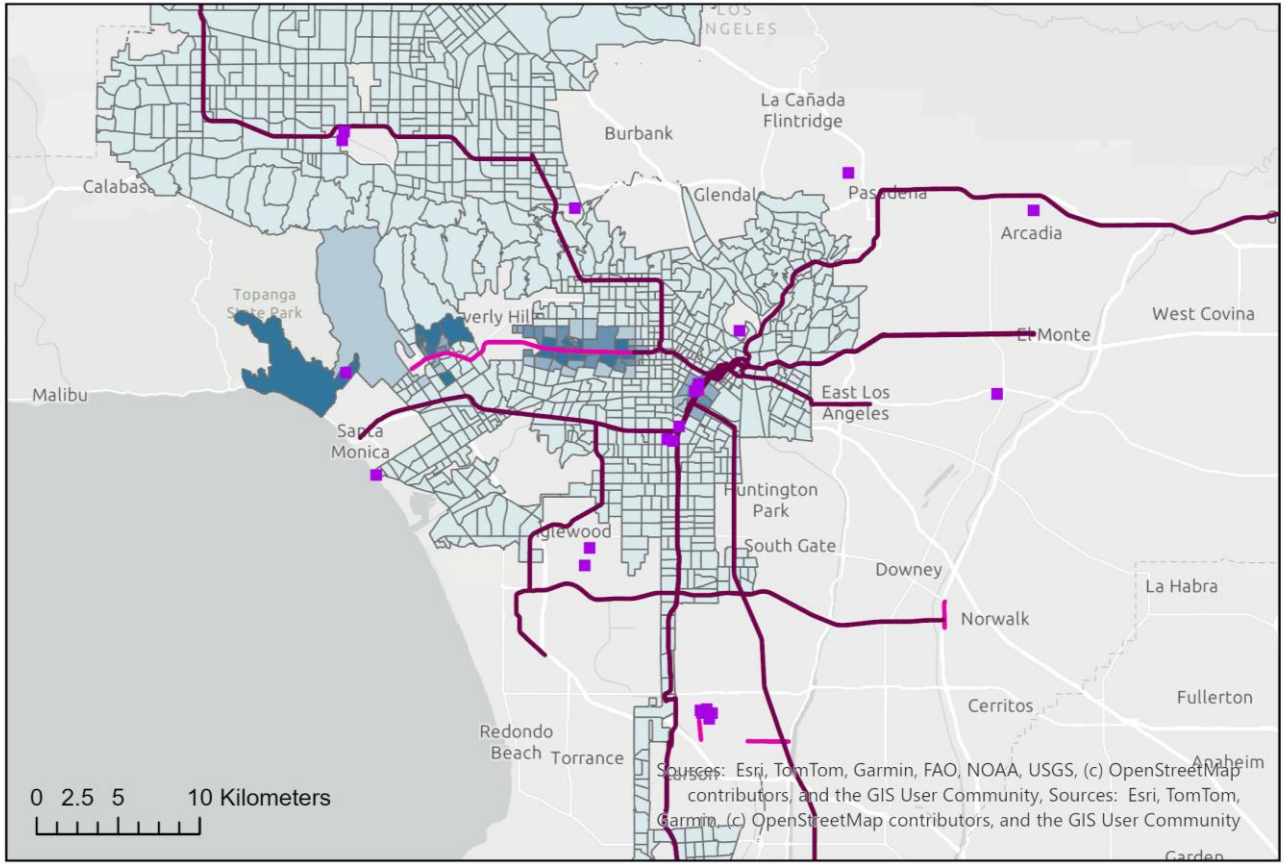
KD Surfaces
- High Improvement
- No Improvement

Network Lines
- 2025 Metro
- 2028 Projects

Venues
- Olympic Sites



Key Findings –
Improvement in Transit Access by Census Tract



Symbology

LA 2028 Olympics
- Venues (Aug 2025 Plans)

LATransit2025
- (Current)

LATransit2028
- (Current + Improved Bus, Rail and Last Mile)

LA County Census Tracts
Improvement in Transit Access
- None
- Low
- Low-Medium
- Medium
- High

- **Strongest gains near new rail corridors –** 32% of improved tracts see medium to high imporvements
- **Improved access for tracts in otherwise underserved areas** – new lines is bringing Metro's network closer to newer neighborhoods
- **Olympic venues are still away from LA Metro's network** and will need *other* impetus for mobility ease and efficient access
- There is still a lot more to do for LA as a region – only 0.05% of the tracts are seeing access gains via these projects.

Data: LA GeoHub, LA Metro | Author Analysis: ArcGIS Pro, MS Excel

Limitations & Conclusion

LIMITATIONS

Proximity, not performance
KD measures distance to transit — not frequency, speed, or reliability. "High improvement" tracts may still have infrequent service.

Tracts, not people
Tract-based metrics, not population-weighted. A tract of 50K residents = same as 5K. Future work should weight by population.

Scenario uncertainty
2028 network based on current plans. Real-world delays, budget constraints, or scope changes could shift outcomes.

CONCLUSION

GIS-based Kernel Density analysis transforms complex transit plans into an intuitive **before-and-after accessibility story**:

- Dark-blue KD surfaces → where transit access sees strongest improvement.
- Dark-blue census tracts → who benefits most from new lines
- Purple venues + pink/magenta lines → direct LA28 spatial reference

As LA approaches the Games, analyses like this help ensure Olympic-driven projects deliver on their promise of a ***lasting, equitable mobility legacy*** — not a one-time spectacle.